

# IT Service Desk

## Standard Operating Procedure

*How to Submit, Track, and Approve Support Tickets*

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For all staff — no technical background required

| Document   | Detail                                               |
|------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| Applies to | All employees, managers, and new hires               |
| Purpose    | Explain how to request IT support and what to expect |
| Owner      | IT Service Desk                                      |
| Version    | 1.0                                                  |

## 1. Purpose of This Document

This document explains how to submit an IT support request, what happens to it after you submit it, and what to expect at each stage. It is written for everyone in the company, not just IT staff, so no technical background is needed to follow it.

Our service desk uses an automated system that reviews every request, tries to solve common problems immediately, and brings in a human engineer whenever a request needs one. Some requests also require a manager's approval before any action is taken. This document walks through all of that.

## 2. Who Should Use This Guide

| Audience                   | What this guide helps you do                                      |
|----------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Employees (any department) | Submit an IT problem and know what to expect back                 |
| Managers and team leads    | Understand the approval step for high-priority requests           |
| New hires                  | Learn the process during onboarding                               |
| Accounting / Finance staff | Know how to report system issues affecting reporting or deadlines |

## 3. How to Submit a Support Request

Submitting a request takes less than a minute. There is no login required.

- 1 Open the support form**  
Use the link provided by IT (bookmark it for quick access next time).
- 2 Fill in your details**  
Enter your full name, your company or department, and your email address.
- Describe your problem**  
**3** Write what is happening in your own words. The more specific you are, the faster and more accurately it gets handled. For example: "I can't connect to Outlook after changing my password" is better than "email broken."
- Click Submit**  
**4** You'll see an on-screen confirmation immediately. You do not need to wait on this page — you'll be contacted by email.

### Tip for a faster resolution

Mention how many people are affected and whether there is a deadline involved. "I can't access my email" is helpful. "Five of us in Accounting can't access email before today's reporting deadline" gets handled with the right urgency.

## 4. What Happens After You Submit

Behind the scenes, your request goes through a short automated review before anyone (human or system) responds to you. Here is what happens, in plain terms:

| Stage                            | What it means for you                                                             |
|----------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Your request is reviewed         | The system reads your description and sorts it by topic and urgency.              |
| It's checked against known fixes | The system looks for a documented solution to your exact type of problem.         |
| A decision is made               | If there's a reliable fix on file, it's applied. If not, it's handed to a person. |
| You receive an email             | Either your fix, or confirmation that a technician is now on it.                  |

**Typical response time is under one minute for issues with a known fix, and the same business day for anything requiring a technician.**

## 5. Understanding Your Ticket Status

Every request is assigned one of these statuses. If you ever check in with IT, this is the language they'll use.

| Status           | What it means                                                                   |
|------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Resolved         | Your issue was fixed automatically. Check your email for the solution.          |
| Escalated        | A person is now handling your request. You'll hear from them directly.          |
| Pending Approval | Your request needs a manager's sign-off before action is taken (see Section 6). |

## 6. For Managers: The Approval Step

Some requests are flagged as high priority, for example, several people affected, or a business deadline at risk. For these, the system pauses and asks a manager to approve or reject the proposed action before anything is sent to the requester. This ensures a person is always in control of higher-impact decisions.

### What a manager sees

A message appears in the team's Slack channel with:

- Who submitted the request and their company/department
- What the issue is and how urgent it is
- What the system proposes to do about it
- Two buttons: Approve and Disapprove

## What to do

1. Read the summary in the Slack message.
2. Click Approve if the proposed action is appropriate. The requester will receive the resolution right away.
3. Click Disapprove if it should go to a technician instead. The request is escalated automatically.

### No response needed?

If nobody responds, the request automatically escalates to a technician after a set waiting period, so nothing is ever left stuck waiting on an approval.

## 7. Example Walkthrough

### Example 1 — Routine request

An employee submits: "I forgot my password and need it reset." The system recognizes this as a common, low-risk request, applies the documented fix, and emails the employee reset instructions within a minute. No manager involvement needed.

### Example 2 — High-priority request

Several employees in Finance submit that they cannot access a shared system before a reporting deadline. Because multiple people and a deadline are involved, this is flagged high priority. A manager receives a Slack message, reviews it, and clicks Approve. The affected staff receive their fix immediately afterward.

### Example 3 — Requires a technician

An employee reports a cracked laptop screen. This type of issue always requires a person, since it involves physical hardware. The system escalates it immediately, and the employee receives an email confirming a technician will follow up.

## 8. Frequently Asked Questions

### Do I need an account or login to submit a request?

No. The support form is open access, no login required.

### How will I be contacted?

By email, using the address you provide on the form. Make sure to double-check it before submitting.

### What if I don't hear back?

Check your spam folder first. If there's still no response within one business day, contact the IT team directly.

### Can I submit on behalf of someone else?

Yes, just use your own contact details so you receive the response, and clearly note who is actually affected in the problem description.

### What kinds of issues should I NOT submit here?

Any request involving immediate safety, active security incidents in progress, or anything urgent enough to require a phone call should go directly to your IT lead rather than through the form.

## 9. Quick Reference Card

Keep this section handy — it summarizes the entire process in one place.

| Step | Action                                                                  |
|------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1    | Open the support form and fill in your details                          |
| 2    | Describe the problem clearly, including who's affected and any deadline |
| 3    | Submit — you'll see an on-screen confirmation                           |
| 4    | Wait for an email — usually within a minute for common issues           |
| 5    | Managers: watch Slack for approval requests on high-priority tickets    |
| 6    | Still stuck? Contact your IT lead directly                              |